# Executive Summary




### Why Growth Stalled

- Mature Greek yogurt category
- Competitive imitation
- Declining category excitement

### Where Growth Can Come From

- All day nutrition occasions
- Functional wellness and plant based
- Habitual repeat consumption

## Situation

**Chobani** transformed Greek yogurt from a niche health product into a mainstream category through natural ingredients, affordability, and customer centric innovation. However, slowing category growth and rising competition now threaten future growth.

## Central Thesis

Chobani's next chapter is not about more yogurt flavors. It is about becoming the **everyday wellness nutrition brand** consumers repeatedly choose across more moments, occasions, and routines.

## Strategic Hypotheses

- **Reposition** Chobani from a Greek yogurt brand to an everyday wellness nutrition brand
- **Expand** innovation into snacks, beverages, functional nutrition, and new consumption occasions
- **Shift** marketing from awareness campaigns to always on, habit reinforcing activation
- **Prioritize** visibility, convenience, and satisfaction to strengthen long term customer habits



# Positioning Strategy




**Core Hypothesis:** Chobani should evolve from a Greek yogurt company into an everyday wellness nutrition brand that helps consumers eat naturally, conveniently, and confidently throughout the day.

## JOBS TO BE DONE

- **Functional:** Provide convenient, high protein, natural nutrition across daily occasions.
- **Emotional:** Help consumers feel healthy, balanced, and in control without overthinking food choices.
- **Social:** Signal a modern, natural, wellness oriented lifestyle without the premium price or identity overhead of specialty health brands.

## TARGET MARKETS

- **Primary:** Mainstream households 25-44, dual-income, time-pressed, health-aware but not health-obsessed
- **Secondary:** Parents of kids 3-12 seeking convenient, trusted, natural snacks for their children
- **Emerging:** Flexitarian and plant based consumers seeking natural alternatives with strong taste and texture

## POINTS OF DIFFERENTIATION

- Real and natural ingredients
- High protein credibility
- Accessible premium pricing
- Founder authenticity and purpose driven story
- DNNA heritage: Delicious, Nutritious, Natural, Accessible
- Customer driven innovation through social listening and co creation

***Research needed:*** JTBD interviews with current users, lapsed users, and non users | Message testing for “everyday wellness nutrition” | Brand stretch research across snacks, beverages, and plant based products




# Innovation Focus through TTOI

**Core Hypothesis:** Chobani's strongest innovation opportunities are not more yogurt flavors alone. Growth should come from expanding when, where, and why consumers choose Chobani.

| TTOI Category | Innovation Hypothesis | Rationale |
|---|---|---|
| **Product Performance** | Higher protein, lower sugar, probiotics, functional nutrition, better plant based taste and texture | These improvements strengthen Chobani's health credibility and respond to current wellness needs without moving too far from the brand's core |
| **Product System** | Flip like snacks, yogurt plus granola, drink plus snack pairings, kids multipacks, cooking formats | Product systems make Chobani more useful across the day and increase repeatable usage occasions |
| **Channel** | Campuses, gyms, workplaces, convenience stores, foodservice | Habit formation depends on availability. Chobani needs to appear where consumers already build food routines |
| **Brand** | Shift from Greek yogurt to "everyday wellness nutrition" | A broader brand frame gives Chobani permission to enter adjacent categories while preserving its natural food identity |
| **Customer Engagement** | Social co creation, recipe communities, limited flavor drops, TikTok and Instagram listening | Chobani historically used consumer input to innovate quickly. Rebuilding this engine can reduce innovation risk |

***Research Needed:*** Consumption occasion mapping | Concept testing for snacks, beverages, and functional nutrition | Willingness to pay research for plant based and high protein products | Trial and repeat analysis by product format

# Marketing Activations

**Core Hypothesis:** Always on, habit reinforcing marketing will generate stronger repeat purchase behavior than on constant novelty. Novelty can attract attention, but habits create durable growth.

## 1. Lifestyle Storytelling

Position Chobani as part of everyday wellness routines, not only as a healthy yogurt product.

**Activation Ideas**

- "Real nutrition for real life" campaign
- Short form content showing breakfast, snack, workout, and family use occasions




## 2. Social and Community Co-Creation

Rebuild Chobani's consumer innovation engine through social listening and user participation.

**Activation Ideas**

- Chobani recipe challenges
- Consumer voted limited flavors
- TikTok and Instagram snack ritual content

## 3. Occasion Based Campaigns

Market Chobani around specific moments of use rather than general product benefits.

**Activation Ideas**

- Morning fuel
- Afternoon snack break
- Post workout recovery
- Kids after school snack

## 4. Partnerships and Distribution Activations

Use partners to make Chobani visible in daily routines outside the grocery aisle.

**Activation Ideas**

- College dining and campus convenient stores
- Gym and fitness studio sampling
- Workplace wellness programs

***Research Needed:*** Message resonance testing | Social listening and share of voice analysis | Retail and channel conversion testing | Trial to repeat measurement by activation

# Habits And Customer Choice

**Core Hypothesis:** In low involvement food categories, long term growth comes from becoming familiar, easy, and repeatedly satisfying within consumers' daily routines.



## CUE: Make it obvious

Consumers often choose familiar products automatically. Chobani should **increase visibility** through recognizable packaging, strong shelf placement, convenience formats, and digital reminders that fit naturally into everyday food routines.



## Craving — Make It Attractive

Consumers repeat products that feel both healthy and enjoyable. Chobani should **use appealing textures, seasonal flavors, and shareable snack experiences** while staying consistent with its natural wellness identity.




## Response — Make It Easy

Habit formation depends on low friction access. Chobani should **expand availability** across convenience stores, campuses, gyms, workplaces, and foodservice environments to support everyday consumption.



## Reward — Make It Satisfying

Consumers repeat products that deliver immediate satisfaction. Chobani should **build on the success of Flip** by focusing on taste, texture contrast, protein satisfaction, and emotional wellness benefits that encourage repeat purchase behavior.




***Research Needed:*** Habit diary study with current and lapsed users | Shelf visibility and packaging recognition testing | Repeat purchase analysis by SKU and occasion | Post purchase satisfaction research

# References

1. Agnihotri, A., & Bhattacharya, S. (2016). Value innovation by Chobani. Ivey Publishing.
2. Clear, J. (2018). Atomic habits. Avery.
3. Keeley, L., Walters, H., Pikkel, R., & Quinn, B. (2013). Ten types of innovation. Wiley.
4. L3. Lafley, A. G., Martin, R. L., McGrath, R. G., Cook, S., Knudstorp, J. V., & Champion, D. (2017, January). Customer loyalty is overrated. Harvard Business Review. https://hbr.org/2017/01/customer-loyalty-is-overrated
5. Moore, G. A. (2014). Crossing the chasm. Harper Business.
6. Ulukaya, H. (2013, October). Chobani's founder on growing a start-up without outside investors. Harvard Business Review. https://hbr.org/2013/10/chobanis-founder-on-growing-a-start-up-without-outside-investors
7. Economic Research Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture. (2021). Per capita consumption of yogurt in the United States from 2000 to 2020. Statista.
8. CNBC & Nielsen. (2022). Year-on-year value growth of Greek yogurt in the United States from 2010 to 2022. Statista